WARSAW Pact which was concluded on 14 May 1955. Pacts and counter pacts, therefore, added to the Cold War tensions.

1959–1962

After the Camp David, it was decided to convene a four-power summit meeting in Paris in May 1960. But the U-2 incident, where the Soviets downed an American U-2 ‘spy plane’ loaded with photographic equipment for gathering of intelligence data, came as a setback to this effort. The diplomatic battle that started after the incident made it inevitable that the Soviets would again raise the Berlin problem. Undoubtedly, the Berlin problem again came to the fore in 1961 and matters became worse with the erection of a 25-mile long Berlin wall on 13 August 1961, which cordoned off the East from the West and with the construction of the Berlin Wall, the ‘Iron Curtain’ became a reality.

In Cuba, the failed Bay of Pigs, a counter-revolution against Fidel Castro, signified the survival of a communist base from where the Soviets could threaten the United States and also cause security threats to other Western nations. Added to this apprehension, in the fall of 1962, a U-2 reconnaissance plane photographed missile-launching sites under construction by the Soviets in Cuba. The two superpowers looked eyeball-to-eyeball and the world was on the verge of witnessing a massive nuclear war. Ultimately, sanity prevailed and the conventional superiority, especially naval superiority of the United States, in the Caribbean, forced Khrushchev to retract. In the words of the Secretary of State, Dean Rusk, “We were eyeball to eyeball, and the other fellow just blinked”. The period following the Cuban Missile Crisis was a period of restraint and both the superpowers took interest in easing of tensions between them. This period is regarded in the history of Cold War as **Détente**.